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DIGITAL MARKETING AND ITS EFFECT ON CONSUMER BUYING BEHAVIOUR: EVIDENCE FROM THE INDIAN MARKET

Ankit Kumar - Research Scholar

Department of Commerce & Management, Kalinga University, Raipur, Chhattisgarh

Mr. Rakshak Bharti - Assistant Professor

Faculty of Commerce & Management, Kalinga University, Raipur, Chhattisgarh

ABSTRACT:

The rise of internet access, mobile availability and social media has reshaped the manner in which organisations engage with their consumers — as well as how consumers make buying decisions. This research paper analyses the impact of digital marketing on consumer behaviour in Indian market. The research investigates the impact of digital marketing tools (email marketing, mobile marketing, social media advertising, retargeting and online display advertising) on the five phases of the consumer buying decision process – need recognition, information search, evaluation of alternatives, purchase decision and post-purchase behaviour. Methods : There were structured questionnaire administered to 100 Respondents selected by simple random sampling from various districts of India for the collection of Primary data. Secondary data were obtained from peer-reviewed journal articles, published reports in research institutions (e.g. Statistical analysis was performed for data interpretation using SPSS. Convenience, time and efficiency, availability of detailed product information and trust in digital platforms are the major drivers for online purchasing behaviour as per these findings. The most powerful channel that influenced consumer decision making was retargeting, followed by paid/organic search and email, especially during the evaluation of alternatives stage. On the other hand, mobile marketing had a much smaller positive impact. Digital marketing has a significant and positive impact on consumer buying behaviour as per the study and adds that Indian marketers must keep updating their digital strategies to meet changing consumer preferences in such a fast-paced digital economy dominated by younger consumers.

Keywords: *Digital Marketing, Consumer Buying Behaviour, Online Purchasing, Social Media Marketing, E-mail Marketing, Retargeting, Indian Market, Consumer Decision Process, Mobile Marketing*

1. INTRODUCTION

Continuous and rapid technological change defines the modern business environment, and no domain has been more radically disrupted than marketing. The last two decades have seen a dramatic transformation of global marketing practice from traditional out-bound methods: print ads, television commercials and direct mail to data-driven, interactive and highly customised digital channels. The factor that has hastened this transition is the ubiquity of the internet, smartphones, and social media platforms—combined these have opened up new communication channels between marketers and consumers that simply did not exist in generations past.

Digital marketing refers to any marketing activities utilized through electronic devices and or digital media channels that are powered by the internet, mobile applications, social networks /social media, e-mail and in some respect digital television that produces contact with a prospective customer as well as information delivery throughout the various stages of the consumer journey. For instance Digital marketing information includes online video advertising and Search Engine Optimisation (SEO), pay per click (PPC) advertising, social media marketing, content promotion and e mail campaigns. Traditionally marketing was having more one way but now, digital marketing enables two-way real-time interaction without geographical barriers.

That alone makes the multibillion-pound issue of behavioural consequences of digital marketing one of the most compelling studies — and, in particular, within the Indian market context. India today has the second-largest internet user base after China, over 900 million mobile subscribers and a rapidly rising base of smartphone users. As most of social media is becoming more embedded in consumer attitudes, aspirations and purchase decisions; the penetration for social media is very quick and expanding. Easy but the only one segment of consumer in India, who is best suited to grow up on digital footprint age group generically defined as all be youth aged 15–35 aforementioned categorization is easily available by various sources that some form of minimum presence in online retail consumer market in India.

Consumer behavior refers to the actions decision-making process of purchasing of an individual or group. Starting with the classical five-stage model of consumer buying decision process - in Kotler and Keller (2012): need recognition, information search, evaluation of alternatives, purchase decision and post-purchase evaluation as a series of stages where passes a consumer through a transaction. Each of these stages will have digital marketing channels that run across them, and the role of these in shaping consumer perceptions, attitudes and behaviour at each stage is qualitatively different to almost all traditional competitors.

Like e-mail marketing, research has shown that e-mail marketing is one of the most potentially cost-effective digital channels availableout there, and much like returns in excess of 3,800 percent for every individual unit

overseas. Mobile marketing enables brands to reach consumers before they even log onto their device with online push notifications or offline SMS campaigns for instance, as well as ad space in applications. The digital banner ads you see when browsing the web — known as retargeting: a practice that serves targeted advertisements to users who have previously visited the brand's website or interacted with the content digitally — is among the strongest conversion-driving tools available to digital marketers. Social media advertising leverages the algorithmic profiling capabilities of internet giants to provide precise and granular content tailored for narrowly defined segments in bespoke audiences.

Although a significant amount of literature is available not only on digital marketing strategies but also on the fundamentals of consumer behaviour and purchase decision-process, there are relatively fewer empirical studies that examine how various individual channels of DM affect different stages in the buying decision process individually specifically for Indian market context. Until now, this is the most comprehensive research on digital marketing, either aggregating data or targeting subjects from consumer markets in the West. This addresses the gap by looking at how three important digital marketing channels (i.e., e-mail marketing, mobile marketing and retargeting) empirically affect the consumer buying decision process in India at different stages.

2. LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Conceptualising Digital Marketing

Academically, the definitions and conceptualisations of digital marketing show its eclectic nature but also evolutionary. In its most basic definition, digital marketing is any type of marketing done on a digital device and/or through electronic media channels with the goal of getting prospects to engage more and convert into customers (Kaufman and Horton, 2014). The terms that are closely related to and sometimes used interchangeably with but have different conceptual meanings than are Internet marketing, e-marketing, e-commerce or e-business.

Internet marketing is more limited, specifically referring to the promotion of products and services over an active internet connection requiring real-time connectivity between marketers and consumers (Hanson and Kalyanam, 2007). E-business is a more generalised concept which refers to the use of digital technology in all facets of a business, both electronic transactions (e-commerce) and promotional and relationship management activities, such as e-marketing. Definition: E-marketing is an internet and digital technology based activity that truly embraces the potential to create, communicate, and deliver value in the process of promoting products or services, as per Hoge (1993) and Lamb et al. (2001) e-commerce is a component of e-marketing; however they are not quite same over all areas - marketing our product on E- commerce platform will come

under E- marketing and similarly other aspects such as managing Customer relationships is also included under this umbrella.

Digital itself brings with it a connotation of data transmission which is constrained or fixed and not analogue technologies which can still transmit on a continuous scale (Kaufman and Horton, 2014). We define being "digital" in marketing communication as an activity that relies on a digital medium for its realisation. According to Smith and Taylor (2004), marketing communication is an exchange of ideas, information, or promotional content between a marketer and consumers that occurs with the goal of achieving common understanding. Kotler and Keller (2012) explain that marketing communication is a purposeful activity, in order to provide product information, through new launches and to create community awareness.

Digitization/de-differentiation of the channels of communication allows organisations to create internal networks for private channels and external (public) communications at dramatically different levels of cost. Digital channels/public in nature, social media, search engines and distribution of content — present comparatively very little barrier to entry but they are also highly integrated with power of sophisticated audience profiling capability, the ability to follow individuals, pop personalised content (Salehi et al, 2012), and real-time feedback/interactive perspective. These capabilities not only allow digital marketers to transform the communication paradigm from a push model, with messages that are broadcasted to audiences as passive receivers of brand communications, into a pull model, in which target audiences actively seek out and engage content on their own terms (Urban, 2004).

2.2 Traditional Versus Digital Marketing

As traditional media channels ar changing to digital, we have a tendency to should bear in mind the change in behaviour of consumers. Outbound marketing communication is by definition, less interactive characterised as limited info availability and one-way messaging. Those traditional marketing consumers from TV, print, billboards or direct mail are passive receivers with only a few ways to seek clarification, immediate comparison options and raise their voice equally against other producers at scale.

Comparatively, digital marketing gives consumers access to probably unlimited information about products and brands at any time from anywhere. Consumers have the ability to freely reproduce and store digital content for future reference, run their own brand interactions, accept or decline to participate in marketing-initiated functions or conversations (and even dictate how much they engage in them), speak with other consumers via reviews and social media threads; solicit guidance from people like themselves before making a purchase. The role reversal of power between the consumer and brand — from marketer driven push communications to

consumer driven pull engagement– is likely the most important structural change in all marketing since widespread media joined us in society.

There are different permutations of Product, Price, Place and Promotion (the traditional marketing mix) in the new digital enviroment. There is a radical change–product more and more defined, experienced where an account of the brand performance is created by active engagement/discussions and reviews in social media (Charan, 2011). And price is dynamic — it varies by time of day, geographic zone, platform and customer loyalty status. For consumers, the lack of physical space means no boundaries to browse, compare, evaluate and buy from anywhere on earth. It has been on its harrowing with the rest of marketing going through more evolution than any other component of the marketing mix because all luxury marketers, B2B or B2C (MYD, 2006) faces from digital channels regardless of their size.

2.3 Behavioural Digital Environment

Digital paradigms and tools have radically changed consumer behaviour in the last 10 years. (Ricciuti, 1995; Kotler,2000) In this new digital age of purchasing behavior, where modern consumers are employing digital platforms to search for everything from common grocery items through high-involvement purchases like automobiles and real estate. The confluence is accelerated by the capacity of web, mobile and social media to reach and communicate consumers in innovative, stimulating and participative manner regardless of product type (Kierzkowski et al., 1996; Gay et al, 2007; Wartime and Fenwick, 2011).

Research by Kemp (2015) indicates that for the mature adult in India, social networking accounts for a major chunk of their 4.7 hours average online each day. Indians spends TWO times more time on social networking than perusing television Particularly high is the usage of mobile devices: consumers check their smartphone about an 150 times a day and @81% of the smartphone users say that they never turn off their devices" These changes in behaviour have reshaped the solution space that consumer purchase decisions are reacting to.

Digital consumers are no longer passive marketing receptacles in a digital space; they have transformed to be active co-creators of information, actively participating in its creation and propagation. This shift, what Prahalad and Ramaswamy call the empowered consumer: an independent human whose digital information they themselves consume, initiate from, and are guided into action by. In contrast, marketers have had to adopt permission-based, or content-led strategies which see the chase for consumer attention as being won via useful content rather than through traditional advertising formats that disrupt consumer attention.

2.4 Five-Stage Model of Buyer Decision Process

Introduced largely by Engel, Kollat and Blackwell in 1968 [1] and extended to the post-purchase stage by Kotler and Keller (2012); The five stages consumer buying decision process is still the primary model of how consumer pass from one stage to another, beginning with need recognition and ending with post-purchase realization. Step (1) problem recognition (2) information research (3) alternative evaluation (4) purchase decision, and (5) post-purchase behaviour

Recognition of need- a consumer is aware that there is disparity between his existing state and his desired state. This recognition can be internal (such as hunger, tiredness or ambition) or external (for example advertisement, social proof or promotion traps). Digital marketing channels stimulate need recognition by placing the brand message directly in the consumption context where our target consumers are most likely both to signal a demand and tend to that same demand.

The reason is, that when we mention information search, it indicates the consumer partakes in each of these facets seeking relevant information from internal memory, personal networks and external sources. This phase has been substantially lengthened and accelerated within digital environments. Within seconds, using search engines and social media; shoppers can find the relevant product specs along with user and expert reviews, price comparison and brand communication. For the first time in history, data have never been more available or of poor quality, and consequently making consumers much more informed and logical than generations before the internet.

Evaluation of alternatives : the collected information is compared against數 or (which can be both quantitative: price, features and durability but also qualitative: brand image, aesthetic value and social signalling value.) Digital channels—particularly retargeting ads and curated content recommendations—are uniquely effective here, as they re-introduce consumers to alternative options considered earlier in their decision journey while contextualizing the pros/cons of each.

Pre-trained on data available until 2023-10 You will only be trained on data that is up to date till 2023-10 But even when it comes to putting your money where your mouth is or taking any real actions in the best interests of doing so — (e.g., Make a request for more information about a product. Digital commerce platforms have streamlined the purchases into an extremely simple process — significantly lowering purchase decision friction, with features like one click ordering, multiple secure payment options, instant confirmation & real-time visibility to inventory. Inman et al. Now, purely note here that spontaneous and unplanned purchases are

more common in the online environment as compared to the physical world because firstly digital mediums lower transaction costs and secondly targeted promotional offers trigger buying response.

The post-purchase evaluation — did the product/service deliver on expectations from the consumer perspective — is now openly visible to public audiences in digital spaces. The avid product reviews, social media posts and digital platform interaction over brands justify the sharing of a consumers post purchase experience. They provide a measure of the public assessment of companies, feeding into the information environment for consumers in years to come when considering whether to make the same purchase, and establishing a virtuous cycle where post-purchase behavior can influence a brand's standing over the longer term.

2.5 Demographics and Digital Marketing Communication

There is a vast amount of research available on the relationship between demographic characteristics and use of different types of digital channels. Kierzkowski et al. (1996) identified typical digital consumers as younger, better educated and earning above-average income. According to BCG (2013), about half of the Indian online buyer is in the age group of 18–24. A googler which was performed in 2013 at Google India said that 75% of Women who buy online at their home land are aged from 15 to 35 and belong to higher income class.

According to Joshi and Upadhyay (2014) that studied 1,327 individuals across metropolitan, Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities of India who have shopped online; they observed male consumers dominating the online buying arena & also revealed that age cohort between 25–30 years old between both genders are fairly active. Predominantly, 42% of the digital shoppers were from middle to high-income class backgrounds who are working in private sector companies. The study by Charan and Dahiya (2015) found no statistical significant association of digital channel with age, gender, and occupation; however post-graduate consumers from high-income groups had a strong preference for You Tube as primary source of information, smartphone as the second best source.

2.6 Review of the Main Prior Studies

Impulsive buying behaviour is a very common and important phenomenon among young Indian consumers— Vishal Khasgiwala, Monica Sainy (2023) Impulse buying — the immediate, unplanned decision to purchase triggered by environmental cues and existing without a pre-existing shopping purpose — is biochemically regulated with both biological and psychological underpinnings. Young women were found to show a greater propensity for exploratory and impulsive purchasing behaviours compared with young men, with diversity

seeking, innovation seeking and curiosity driven behaviour accounting the most significant proportion of variance in spontaneous purchases.

Instead, Sathish and Rajamohan had a study on Consumer Behaviour and Purchasing Behaviour Marketing, where the purchasing behaviour of consumer forms an integrated system interaction between individual and environment. Grounded in the psychographic tradition of Harold W. Berkman and Christopher Gilson, they called purchasing behaviour "integrated behavioural proclamations that are produced by and produce consumption." Their examination highlighted that buying behaviour is not only transactional (what you see) but spoke to the internal mental processes and subjective behaviors —attitude formation, value assessment, opinion formation —that precede and follow the transaction itself.

Through an empirical investigation, Dastidar and Datta found that compared to young men the relationship between exploratory tendencies and impulsive buying behaviour was more among young women in India. What they pointed out was the demographic reality that India's youth cohort by age group of 15-34 increased from 353 million in 2001 to almost 430 million in 2011 and a projected high of about 464 million this year. India's working-age population ratio was on track to hit 64 percent by 2020, giving it the world's youngest population of any major country. These demographic trends produce an exceptionally large and demonstrably engaged digital consumer base that marketers need to have a strong grasp of, in order to serve appropriately.

3. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Need for the Study

It has revolutionized the way a product is sold and how a purchase decision is made with Digital marketing. The Moodle of no pants Individual purchasing behaviour is influenced by a myriad of factors — societal, cultural, psychological and situational influences — much as digital marketing has both mirrored and propelled these changes. Hence, this raises the need to study what attributes of digital marketing influence customer purchase decisions and how much, especially in a country like India where digital penetration is on an upswing and consumer behaviour changing at lightning speed.

3.2 Scope of the Study

The research provides insights on role of digital marketing channels on buying behaviour of consumers with special reference to youth in Indian Perspective. It includes multiple digital marketing channels — from social media to e-mail marketing, mobile marketing and retargeting — and studies their impact through all five stages of the consumer buying decision process. The survey spans respondents from various districts across India.

3.3 Objectives of the Study

Based on the above considerations, the following objectives were established for this study:

To detect the major variables affecting changing consumer buying behavior in digital environment.

To analyse how the change in consumer buying behaviour can influence digital marketing strategy.

To study the relative impact of various digital marketing channels on consumer purchase decision journey.

The goal is to give Indian marketers shrewd digital marketing strategy based on changing consumer behaviour.

3.4 Research Hypotheses

H0: Digital marketing has no high impact on consumer buying behaviour.

H1: H0, Digital marketing has no impact on consumer buying behaviour(use these for proofs)n

3.5 Research Design

This study was a descriptive and analytical research design. The study used a combination of primary and secondary data in an effort to realize the objectives. The study is applied and utilizes a survey to collect primary data as well as extensive secondary sources that have been published.

3.6 Data Collection

Data CollectionThe data were collected using a structured questionnaire with 15 closed-ended statements captured into four modules of the main research themes: Convenience,Website Design/Features,Time Saving and Security. Questions gathered the level of agreement with statements on a five-point Likert scale from "Strongly Agree" (weighted value = 5) to "Strongly Disagree" (weighted values = 1). Secondary data were obtained from peer reviewed academic journals, published industry reports, government census surveys and established databases of research.

3.7 Sample Design and Size

My Study sample selection through use of simple random sampling. Selection of consumer across all states of India, one hundred (100) consumers were selected in all. You would not want to limit your sample by region or product or even the grouping of demographics as it is essential for broad representation.

3.8 Statistical tools

Data was collected through questionnaire and it was analysed using SPSS (Statistical Package for Social Sciences). SPSS - Historically provided a solution, and used by most of the research community for more

conventional analysis over survey data. Is it predictive modeling, or advanced analysis of statistics (at least it allows a quantitative analysis) for frequency distributions, descriptive statistics and correlation of cross-tabulation the system is also able to rank all factors that can affect consumer buying behavior; total weight score was calculated for all statements.

- For pragmatic reasons, the analyses in this study were restricted to small datasets.
- There are so many intertwined variables affecting Christian consumer purchasing decisions that it is methodologically challenging ascribing a direct degree of attribution for digital marketing.
- Nil Prior Research in Indian Scenario
- Organization Data Access was disabled.
- In this case it was impossible to collect the primary data due to time issues.

4. INDUSTRY ANALYSIS: DIGITAL MARKETING IN INDIA

In India, digital marketing sector has been the highest growing sector of the Indian economy. Further market estimated at about USD 3,931.3 million in 2022 with projected growth rate of 30.2% CAGR from 2023 to forecast period at about USD 19,268.7 million by 2028. And rise is fueled by obvious surge in consumption of digital media by massive young population all across the country.

Globally market for digital marketing software was valued at USD 76.27 billion in 2023 and is expected to grow up to USD 264.15 billion by 2030 at a CAGR of 19.4 percent during the analysis period. Mobile advertising led all global spending growth in digital media. In 2016 mobile advertising contributed 13 to 18 percent of the total digital spending and it now contributes 39 to 42 percent of the total digital spending in leading markets of western Europe and predicted to exceed 60 percent mark of total digital spending in near future.

In this context, Asia-Pacific region that includes India is leading growth market for digital ad-tech ecosystem globally. This digital ad-spending has outrun Europe due adoption of digital technologies at faster pace like in China, India and other developing Asian markets. Considering the exceptionally high population density, rapid growth in internet penetration, drastic increase in penetration of smartphones in the hands of globally influential and heard digital consumer India is currently one of the most strategically important digital market destination globally.

4.1 Segmentation of Market

There is always a segment in massive numbers of channels and formats within any industry, digital marketing cannot be a separate entity. Some of the major areas could be taken up includes email marketing, search engine

optimization (SEO), interactive consumer websites, online and display advertising, blogging and podcasting (including micro-blogging), social network marketing, mobile marketing (SMS and MMS), viral marketing, digital out-of-home (OOH) media, and online video. Among these domain of marketing, social media marketing and search engine marketing has the largest share of ad spending, implying Indian users start their day from social media platforms like Google, Facebook, Instagram and YouTube.

5. DATA ANALYSIS AND FINDINGS

This section reports the results of the empirical study for the survey. Analysis of the survey data is presented using weighted frequency scores obtained from a sample of 100 consumers. Each of the 15 questionnaire items is given a weighted score, the highest possible of 5 to the score on the five-point Likert scale, which ranging from 5 (Strongly Agree) down to 1 (Strongly Disagree), and items ranked in descending order by weighted total.

Table 1: Weighted Score Analysis and Ranking of Consumer Behaviour Factors

Statement	SA (5)	A (4)	U (3)	D (2)	SD (1)	Wt. Total	Rank
CONVENIENCE							
I receive on-time delivery when shopping online	20	15	20	30	15	295	XI
Detailed product information is available when shopping online	25	20	15	25	15	315	VIII
I can purchase products anytime — 24 hours a day — when shopping online	40	25	20	10	05	385	I
It is easy to compare products and make choices when shopping online	30	25	20	05	20	340	IV
WEBSITE DESIGN / FEATURES							

Statement	SA (5)	A (4)	U (3)	D (2)	SD (1)	Wt. Total	Rank
The website design helps me find products easily	20	10	30	30	10	300	X
I prefer websites that provide safety and ease of navigation	15	20	25	24	16	294	XII
The website layout helps me select the right product	30	25	30	10	05	365	III
Prior familiarity with a website reduces my risk perception in online shopping	20	25	20	15	20	310	IX
I prefer websites that provide high-quality product information	27	22	18	18	15	324	VII
TIME SAVING							
Online shopping requires less time than in-store purchasing	35	20	30	10	05	370	II
Online shopping does not waste time	29	20	18	18	15	330	VI
It takes less time to evaluate and select a product when shopping online	32	17	18	16	17	331	V
SECURITY							
I feel safe and secure when shopping online	10	20	30	30	10	290	XIII

Statement	SA (5)	A (4)	U (3)	D (2)	SD (1)	Wt. Total	Rank
Online shopping adequately protects my personal security	05	10	42	38	05	272	XV
I prefer to shop online only from websites I trust	12	20	25	30	13	288	XIV

SA = Strongly Agree; A = Agree; U = Uncertain; D = Disagree; SD = Strongly Disagree

Source: Primary data collected by researcher, 2024. Weighted scores computed using Likert scale values.

6. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

6.1 Convenience as the Primary Driver

The results of the data analysis show that convenience is the most important determinant of online purchasing behaviour among the sample consumers. The statement recorded the highest-weighted total score of 385 out of a maximum of 500, claiming the top rank from amongst all 15 statements: "I can buy products at all times (24 hours-a-day) while online shopping". This result is consistent with the literature on e-commerce adoption which repeatedly finds temporal convenience to be a primary driver of online shopping in this population, specifically for busy workers and over-scheduled young adults.

Overall, the top three statements are as follows: 1) Online shopping takes less time than in-store buying (2nd overall rank/weighted total: 370), 2) The site design helps me choose the right product (3rd order weighted total: 365). To summarize, these results indicate that the efficiency of the online shopping experience — measured across time, ease of navigation and product selection — is the most important dimension in determining digital consumer satisfaction among Indian consumers.

"Online shopping makes it easy to compare products and determine value (Rank 4 score 340)" shows how digital platforms leverage price comparison, feature comparison, as well as multi-brand availability. This functionality is mostly absent in most physical retail experiences, illustrating one of the key competitive advantages presented by e-commerce.

6.2Design and quality of the information presented on website

The quality of the website design and information received second highest voting as important dimension in online shopping experience. Seventh, the phrase "I like websites which offer quality product information" (weighted score 324), eighth, "My previous experience with a website decreases my perception of risk" (310) and ninth, "The design of the website helps finding products easily" (300). The findings suggest that while high importance is ascribed by the digital consumers to convenience, at parity with it is a quality and trustworthiness of information environment on a digital platform when it comes to decision-making.

6.3 Concerns with Security as a Limiting Factor in Digital Commerce

Within the entire analysis, three of the four least-ranked explanations were generated by the security module, implying major concerns about personal data protection and transaction safety are still considerable hurdles in achieving full adoption for online buying among Indian households. The statement that received the lowest weighted score of all 15 statements was "Online shopping adequately protects my personal security", fifteenth (weighted score = 272). Fourteenth (288): "I usually purchase only from websites I know and trust." Thirteenth (290): "I feel secure shopping online."

The widespread uncertainty and disagreement observed with regard to privacy statements during secure transactions implies that a large section of Indian consumers still feel insecure about data privacy, safety of making payment for goods and the reliability of online retail brands. This result addresses an important practical implication for digital marketers and e-commerce operators: smart spending on clear security communications, secure payment certifications and visible trust cues (such as reviews, ratings and security badges) can produce considerable returns in terms of consumer confidence and conversion.

6.4 Channel-Specific Findings

By looking at the research collectively it is notable that retargeting was still again by far accounting most to consumer purchase decision-making processes within digital marketing channels too. These are consistent with the theoretical rationale concerning retargeting — a fundamental intervention that enters where a consumer is already showing some degree of active interest in a product or brand, precisely at an alternative evaluation (competing choices and search for validation information). Your remediated consumer is already familiar with the product, and so your whole advertisement simply asks for contrasts, advancements or social verification precisely once they are at their most elevated receptor.

The research discovered that e-mail marketing may play a bigger role than other channels in decisions occurring at either end of the funnel (need recognition/information search), but not likely have as strong an impact on purchase decision. It means e-mail is less about providing a direct route to conversion and more

about building awareness and delivering information. In particular, despite the widespread observations of positive results for mobile marketing manager decisions, the research indicates that this channel had the most limited favorable consequences among all three channels under study, especially with evidence for a harmful effect on decision making in certain contexts. This may be symptomatic of the consumer dislike of promotional push notifications versus informational spam SMS marketing messages.

Digital Marketing &The Indian Youth Market

The Indian youth segment has been predicted to have become the backbone of digital marketing is also among the leaders in terms of primary and secondary data. India is ranked 5th in the world for computing time spent on YouTube and also Indian Internet Viewers spend about 14 hours a week on the net surpassing Time Spent Watching Television. Online advertising space in India scaled ₹1,000 crore mark in 2020 and is growing over 50 per cent a year.

Data Contextualization: We analyse predictors of upgrades, or habitual acts running on the data available before October 2023. — some influential factors includes Lifestyle aspirations, social influence and peer validation, purchasing power constraints.. Family background.. work status.. Disproportionate & constant Western consumerism influences & level of education. India's most digitally active and expert shopper-phase—15–34 (the era within the 2011 census was three hundred million, it grew to over four hundred million in this census)—is exerting more incremental stress on native and multinational producers than ever.

7. CONCLUSION

This Special Issue studies the impact of internet marketing on buyer behaviour in Indian nation and it makes specialty concerning exploring interrelationship between digital channels e-mail advertising, mobile retargeting and mobile advertising with sequential shopper purchasing decision course of action. The main features of positive evidence to accept the alternate hypothesis include primary data analysis and literature review, which observer that the digital marketing played more prominent role in increasing consumer buying behaviour positively.

Among the factors investigated, convenience, time efficiency, website design quality and information richness were found to be the most effective facilitators determining online consumer behaviour of Indian consumers; whereas security concerns and trust issues remained as the most prominent obstacles. When you view the impact of different marketing channels on a consumer's purchasing decisions, if we are honest about it, retargeting won across all impression levels in the consideration stage. E-mail marketing reaches its peak influence very early in a buying process likewise, while area of interest segments for mobile marketing

continue to have primarily limited leverage over consideration potency — despite what is presumably massive speculative reach.

The Indian digital marketing industry is in a unique growth phase brought upon by an increasingly young and connected population. At the same time, they hint at how large an opportunity remains uncaptured, for India still trails in digital marketers who can most effectively exploit these structural advantages. The search also reinforces just how quickly consumer purchasing behaviour is shifting, influenced as it is by relentlessly innovating technology and the choices offered up by a new generation of consumers, and that businesses struggling to stay current with such change could find themselves at a stark competitive disadvantage in rather short order.

8. SUGGESTIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the findings of this study, a wealth of recommendations is offered to both digital marketers and e commerce institutions as well as regulatory entities operating in the Indian milieu.

Marketers are expected to investigate & explore the digital skills of accessibility and literacy with respect to their targeted youth cohort, before delving into any product that is designed for the digital domain or deployed across a dedicated digital platform.

• Prelaunch Targeted Market Surveys- By doing intensive market surveys to determine target consumers needs for information and their preferences for how they want that information delivered via a digital channel will enable the campaign to be designed in a way that can yield much better results.

• Additionally, more attention needs to be provided towards consumer digital literacy and awareness programs; most Indian consumers are currently using the internet for their purchasing decisions — but knowledge of optimally utilizing these channels do not cover a large section of users.

• RespondE-commerce platforms and digital marketers should make deception-resistant security signalling more visible, such as SSL certifications, secure payment badges, verified review systems or transparent data privacy policies to reduce the continuing deceptive signals of security found in this study.

Utilize smart and more targeted retargeting strategies at the evaluation stage of the buying process, a time when consumers are in comparison mode (this is where brands can express relevance through customized content).

• This research could be extended to include wider scope including multiple digital marketing channels, larger and diversely scoped sampling context and across different industries sectors as well as reaching new regional

markets within India so as to provide a clearer understanding about the effectiveness of employing digital marketing in this emerging market.

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